

Mount Kenya University

Unlocking Infinite Possibilities

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Unit Name: Advanced Cryptography

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Project Title: Classical to Block Cipher Cryptographic Toolkit

Selected Technologies: Python, VS Code, Cryptographic Simulators, Statistical Tools

Online Portfolio / GitHub Link:

<https://github.com/Abduz12/advanced/tree/main/advanced>

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Week 1: Cryptography Environment Setup

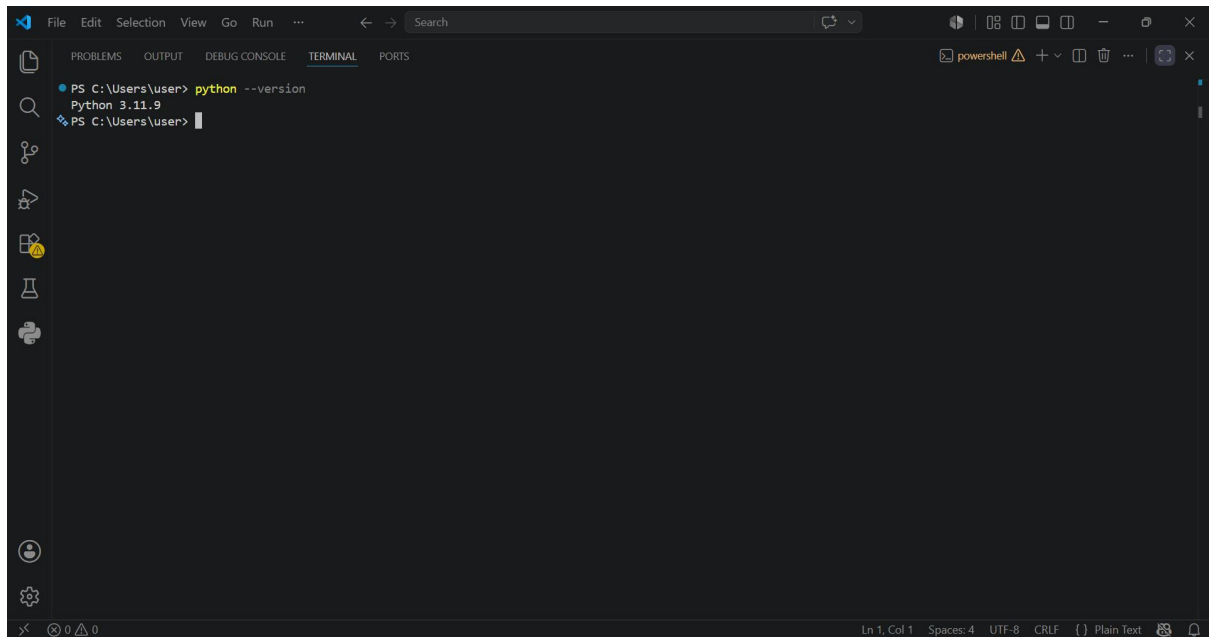


Fig 1: Installation of Python and VS Code

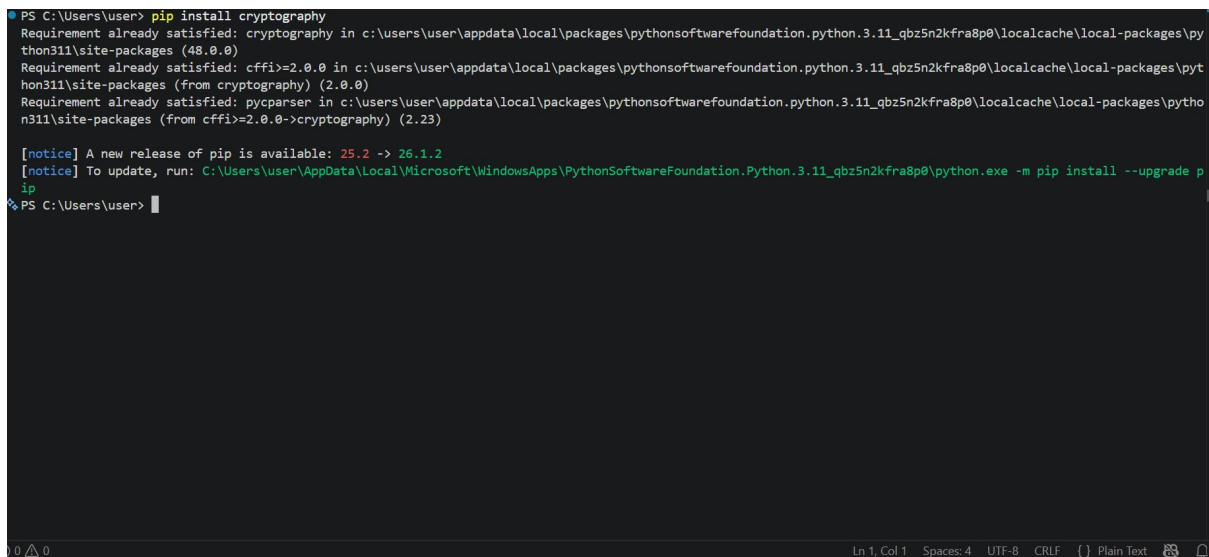
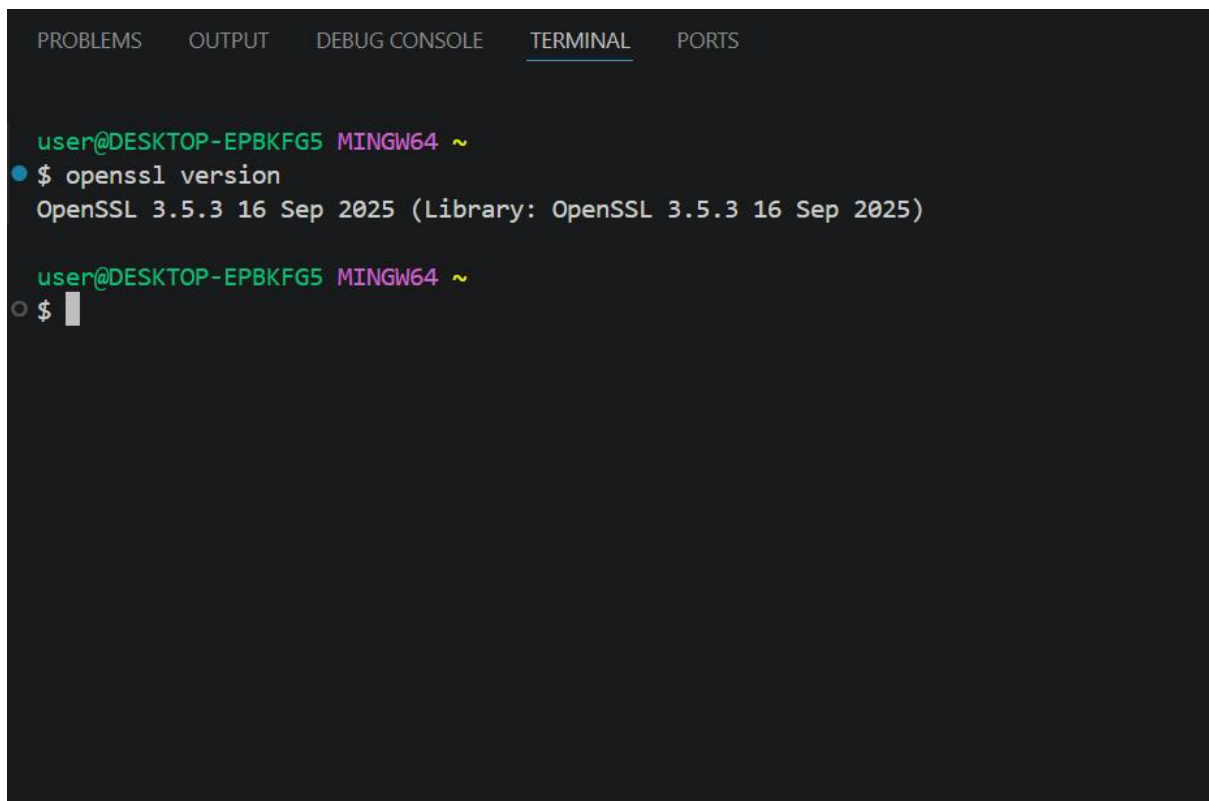


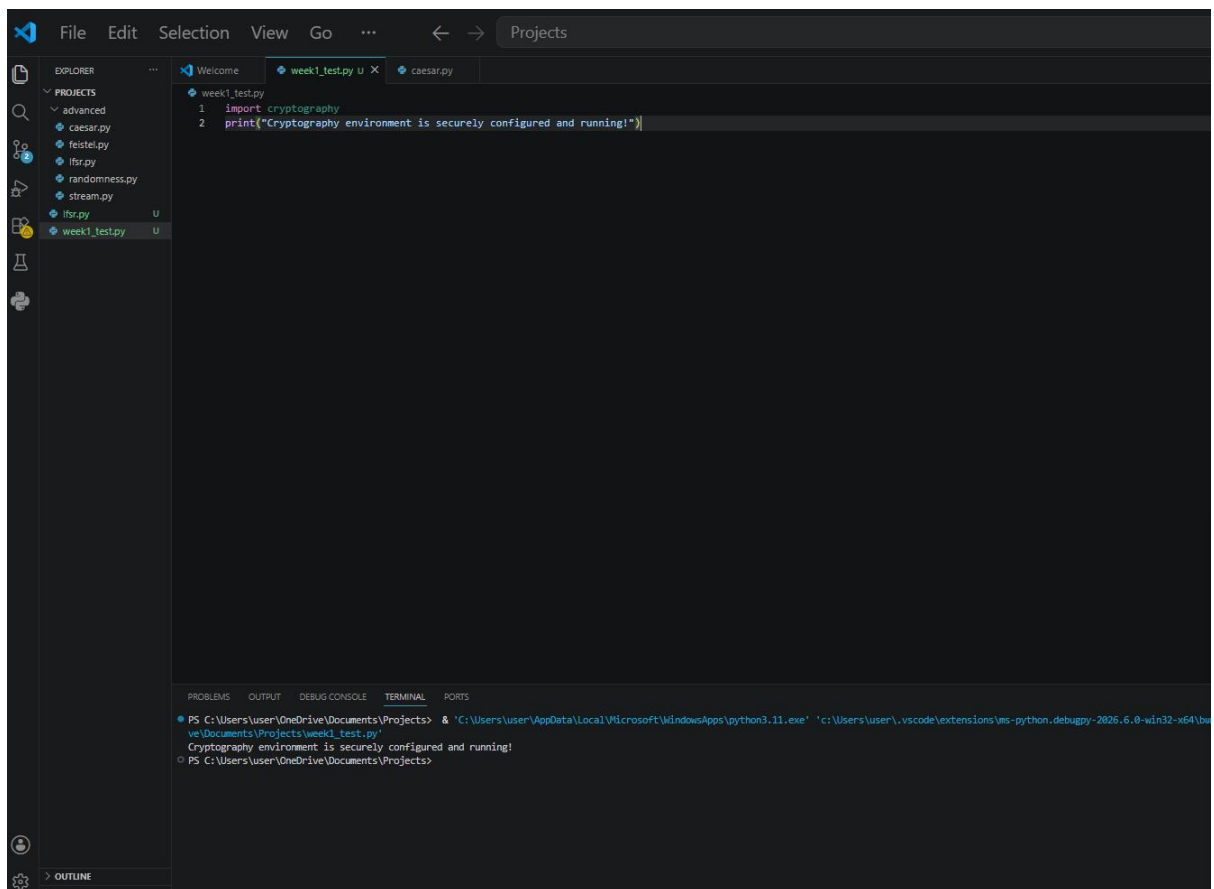
Fig 2: Installation of Cryptography Libraries



A screenshot of a terminal window with a dark background. At the top, there are tabs labeled 'PROBLEMS', 'OUTPUT', 'DEBUG CONSOLE', 'TERMINAL' (which is selected and underlined), and 'PORTS'. The terminal shows a prompt 'user@DESKTOP-EPBKFG5 MINGW64 ~' followed by the command '\$ openssl version'. The output is 'OpenSSL 3.5.3 16 Sep 2025 (Library: OpenSSL 3.5.3 16 Sep 2025)'. Below this, the prompt appears again, followed by a '\$' and a cursor.

```
user@DESKTOP-EPBKFG5 MINGW64 ~  
$ openssl version  
OpenSSL 3.5.3 16 Sep 2025 (Library: OpenSSL 3.5.3 16 Sep 2025)  
  
user@DESKTOP-EPBKFG5 MINGW64 ~  
$
```

Fig 3: OpenSSL Installation Test



A screenshot of the Visual Studio Code (VS Code) interface. The Explorer sidebar on the left shows a project named 'advanced' with several files: 'caesar.py', 'feistel.py', 'itrs.py', 'randomness.py', 'stream.py', 'itrs.py', and 'week1_test.py'. The 'week1_test.py' file is selected and open in the editor. The code in the editor consists of two lines: '1 import cryptography' and '2 print("cryptography environment is securely configured and running!")'. The bottom panel shows the 'TERMINAL' tab, which displays the command prompt output: 'PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects> & 'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Microsoft\WindowsApps\python3.11.exe' 'c:\Users\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python.debugpy-2025.6.0-win32-x64\bin\python.exe' 'c:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects\week1_test.py'' followed by the output 'Cryptography environment is securely configured and running!'. The prompt then returns to 'PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects>'.

```
File Edit Selection View Go ... < > Projects  
EXPLORER  
PROJECTS  
  advanced  
    caesar.py  
    feistel.py  
    itrs.py  
    randomness.py  
    stream.py  
    itrs.py  
    week1_test.py  
week1_test.py  
1 import cryptography  
2 print("cryptography environment is securely configured and running!")  
  
PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS  
PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects> & 'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Microsoft\WindowsApps\python3.11.exe' 'c:\Users\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python.debugpy-2025.6.0-win32-x64\bin\python.exe' 'c:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects\week1_test.py'  
Cryptography environment is securely configured and running!  
PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects>
```

Fig 4: Local Encryption Script Execution

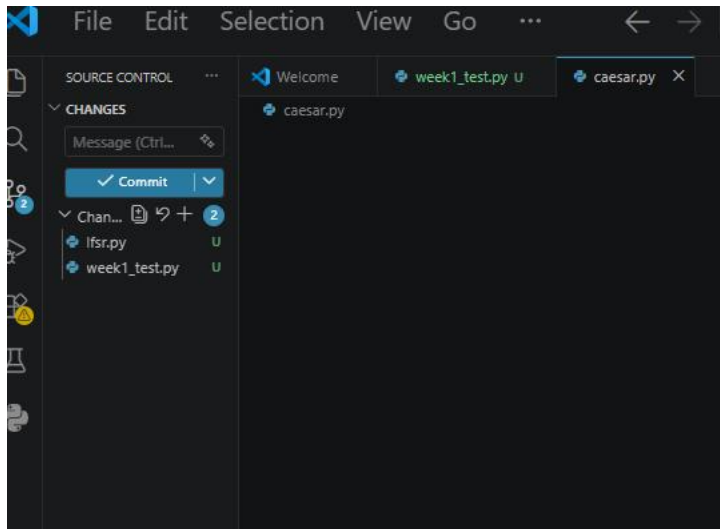


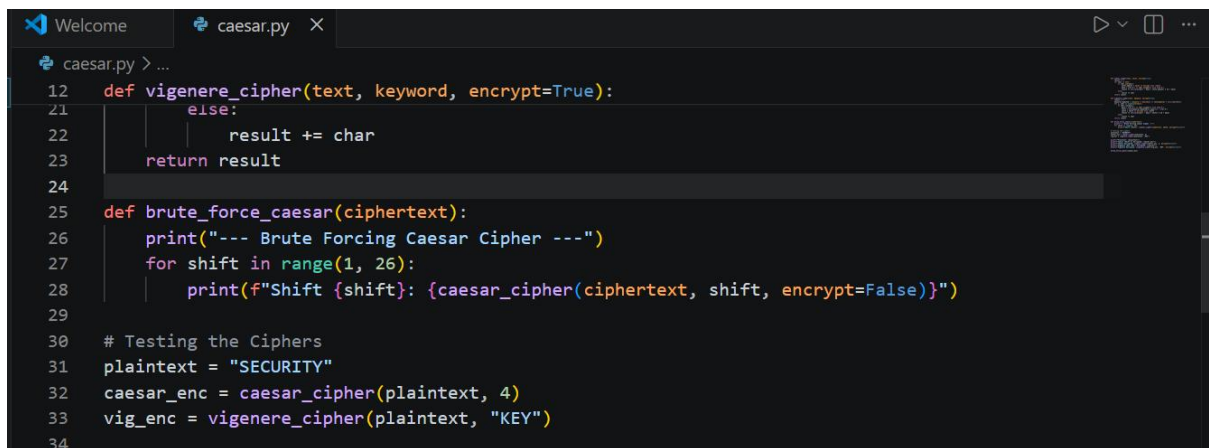
Fig 5: GitHub Repository Initialization

Student Reflection: Successfully installed and configured the cryptography development environment. Python, VS Code, and the Python Cryptography library were set up. OpenSSL was verified for secure key generation, and a GitHub repository was initialized to maintain professional version control and cybersecurity workflow reporting.

Week 2: Classical Cryptography and Cipher Design

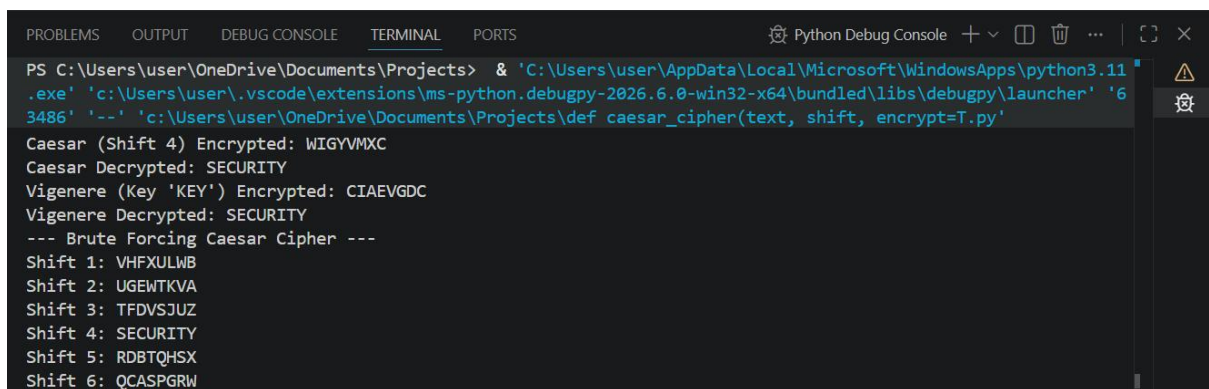
Comparison and Implementation of Caesar and Vigenère Ciphers

Implemented Caesar and Vigenère ciphers in Python. I observed that the Vigenère cipher provides enhanced security over the Caesar cipher by utilizing multiple alphabets via a keyword, which effectively reduces redundancy and makes basic frequency analysis much more difficult for attackers.



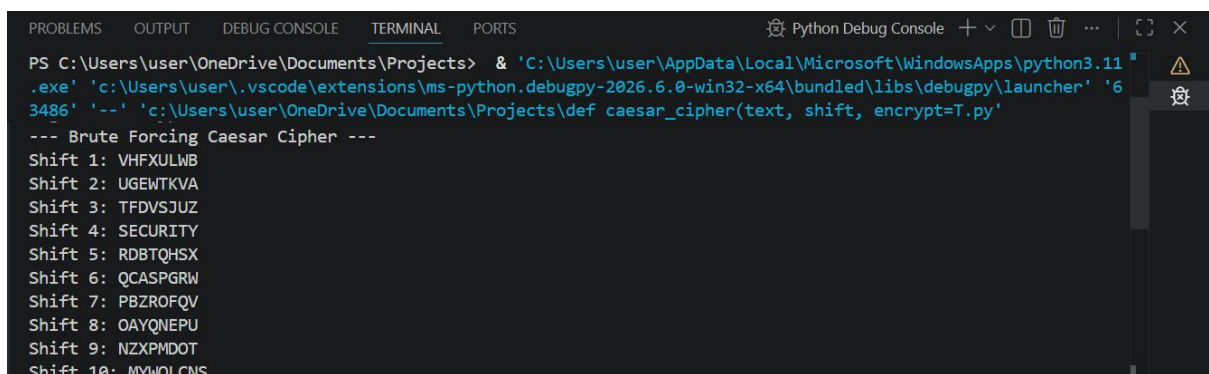
```
12 def vigenere_cipher(text, keyword, encrypt=True):
13     else:
14         result += char
15     return result
16
17 def brute_force_caesar(ciphertext):
18     print("--- Brute Forcing Caesar Cipher ---")
19     for shift in range(1, 26):
20         print(f"Shift {shift}: {caesar_cipher(ciphertext, shift, encrypt=False)}")
21
22 # Testing the Ciphers
23 plaintext = "SECURITY"
24 caesar_enc = caesar_cipher(plaintext, 4)
25 vig_enc = vigenere_cipher(plaintext, "KEY")
26
```

Fig 1: Python implementation of Caesar and Vigenère cipher functions.



```
PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects> & 'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Microsoft\WindowsApps\python3.11
.exe' 'c:\Users\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python.debugpy-2026.6.0-win32-x64\bundle\libs\debugpy\launcher' '6
3486' '--' 'c:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects\def caesar_cipher(text, shift, encrypt=T.py'
Caesar (Shift 4) Encrypted: WIGVVMXC
Caesar Decrypted: SECURITY
Vigenere (Key 'KEY') Encrypted: CIAEVGDC
Vigenere Decrypted: SECURITY
--- Brute Forcing Caesar Cipher ---
Shift 1: VHFUXLWB
Shift 2: UGEWTKVA
Shift 3: TFDVSJUZ
Shift 4: SECURITY
Shift 5: RDBTQHSX
Shift 6: QCASPGRW
```

Fig 2: Terminal output showing successful encryption and decryption of plaintext using both ciphers



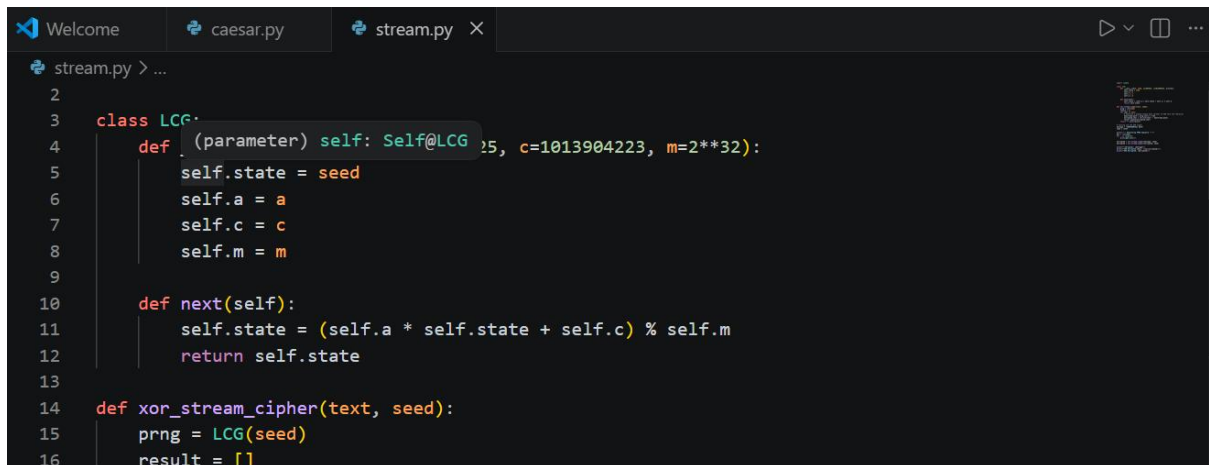
```
--- Brute Forcing Caesar Cipher ---
Shift 1: VHFUXLWB
Shift 2: UGEWTKVA
Shift 3: TFDVSJUZ
Shift 4: SECURITY
Shift 5: RDBTQHSX
Shift 6: QCASPGRW
Shift 7: PBZROFQV
Shift 8: OAYQNEPU
Shift 9: NZXPMDOT
Shift 10: MYWQICNS
```

Fig 3: Terminal output demonstrating a brute-force attack simulation on the Caesar Cipher.

Student Reflection: Implemented Caesar and Vigenère ciphers. I observed that the polyalphabetic Vigenère cipher provides enhanced security over the Caesar cipher by utilizing a keyword, effectively reducing redundancy and making basic frequency analysis much more difficult for attackers to execute.

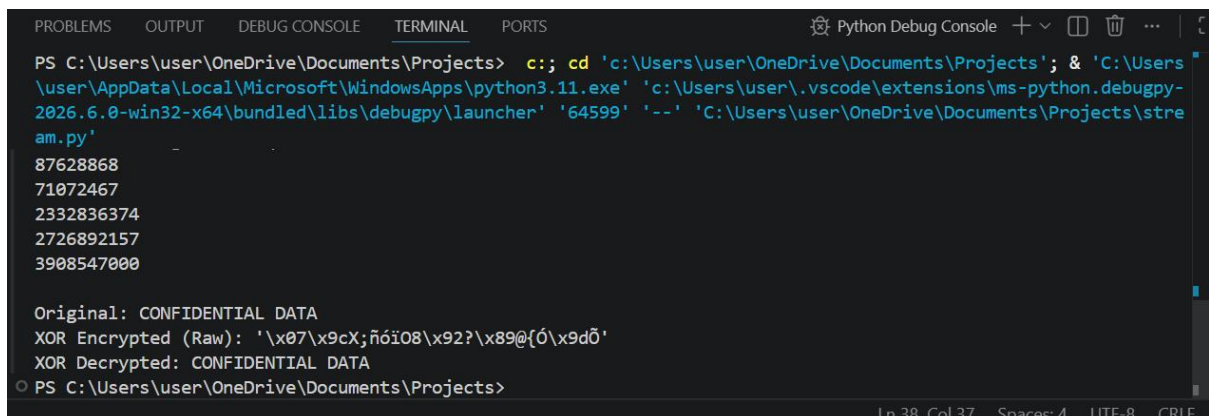
Week 3: Stream Ciphers and Randomness Testing

Title: Implementation of Stream Cipher Systems and Random Sequence Analysis



```
stream.py > ...
2
3 class LCG:
4     def __init__(self, seed, a=1, c=1013904223, m=2**32):
5         self.state = seed
6         self.a = a
7         self.c = c
8         self.m = m
9
10    def next(self):
11        self.state = (self.a * self.state + self.c) % self.m
12        return self.state
13
14    def xor_stream_cipher(text, seed):
15        prng = LCG(seed)
16        result = []
```

Fig 1: Implementation of the Linear Congruential Generator (LCG) class in Python.



```
PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS Python Debug Console
PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects> c:: cd 'c:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects'; & 'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Microsoft\WindowsApps\python3.11.exe' 'c:\Users\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python.debugpy-2026.6.0-win32-x64\bundled\libs\debugpy\launcher' '64599' '--' 'C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects\stream.py'
87628868
71072467
2332836374
2726892157
3908547000

Original: CONFIDENTIAL DATA
XOR Encrypted (Raw): '\x07\x9cX;ñóï08\x92?\x89@{ó\x9dõ'
XOR Decrypted: CONFIDENTIAL DATA
PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects>
```


Fig 2: Terminal output displaying the pseudorandom sequence generated by the LCG.

```
Original: CONFIDENTIAL DATA
XOR Encrypted (Raw): '\x07\x9cX;ñóï08\x92?\x89@{Ó\x9dÕ'
XOR Decrypted: CONFIDENTIAL DATA
PS C:\Users\user\OneDrive\Documents\Projects>
```

Fig 3: Terminal output showing the original, raw encrypted, and decrypted data using the XOR stream cipher.

Student Reflection: Developed a Linear Congruential Generator (LCG) and applied it to an XOR stream cipher. The exercises highlighted the critical difference between true randomness and pseudorandomness, emphasizing that stream cipher security relies heavily on the unpredictability and period of its keystream.

Week 4: Block Cipher Design and AES

Title: Advanced Encryption Standard (AES) and Block Cipher Operations

The screenshot shows a VS Code editor window with the following components:

- Menu Bar:** File, Edit, Selection, View, Go, and Projects.
- Explorer Panel:** Displays the file structure with folders for 'PROJECTS' and 'week1_testpy'. The file 'aes.py' is selected.
- Editor Panel:** Shows the code in 'aes.py'. The code imports Fernet from cryptography, generates a key, creates a cipher, and prints the generated AES key. It then defines a plaintext string, encrypts it, and prints the encrypted and decrypted versions.

```

1 from cryptography.fernet import Fernet
2 key = Fernet.generate_key()
3 cipher = Fernet(key)
4 print(f"Generated AES Key: {key.decode()}")
5
6 plaintext = b"Highly confidential patient records."
7 ciphertext = cipher.encrypt(plaintext)
8 print(f"Encrypted: {ciphertext}")
9 print(f"Decrypted: {cipher.decrypt(ciphertext).decode()}")

```

Fig 1: Python implementation of AES key generation and encryption using the Cryptography library.

```
PS C:\Users\User\OneDrive\Documents\Projects> cd .
Debugpy/launcher: "61792" ["-"] ["c:\Users\User\OneDrive\Documents\Projects\advanced\aes.py"]
Generated AES Key: snh0Ktalce08KvYfERad_06_87UJwxxzFg741QGRl=
Encrypted: b'gAAAAABgJgJeV6U61LCOE-3PwcoQowGAP9G0G6sYA-g3e2-5nUDC3syTVthmRVEzr19Th7eG1x0y-8Dq1wZcpHk-YgRtUurLqBtkvpQ76kygB8U7C1QcGSHUMdR--29h'
Decrypted: Highly confidential patient records.
PS C:\Users\User\OneDrive\Documents\Projects>
```

Fig 2: Terminal output showing the generated Symmetric Key and successful AES encryption/decryption.

Student Reflection: AES encryption was implemented to securely encrypt text and data using symmetric keys. The practical workflow demonstrated successful encryption, decryption, and secure key handling, emphasizing the necessity of robust key management in modern block cipher operations.

Week 5: Public Key Cryptography (RSA)

Title: Implementation of RSA Encryption and Key Management

```
File Edit Selection View Go ... Projects
EXPLORER
- PROBLEMS
- week1_test.py
- caesary
- caesary_advanced
- aespy
- rasy
- streampy
- week1_test.py
1 from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.asymmetric import rsa, padding
2 from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import hashes
3
4 private_key = rsa.generate_private_key(public_exponent=65537, key_size=2048)
5 public_key = private_key.public_key()
6 print("RSA Public and Private Keys Generated.")
7
8 message = b'Secret secure message.'
9 ciphertext = public_key.encrypt(message, padding.OAEP(mgf=padding.MGF1(algorithm=hashes.SHA256()), algorithm=hashes.SHA256(), label=None))
10 print(f"Encrypted (Raw): {ciphertext.hex()}")
11
12 decrypted = private_key.decrypt(ciphertext, padding.OAEP(mgf=padding.MGF1(algorithm=hashes.SHA256()), algorithm=hashes.SHA256(), label=None))
13 print(f"Decrypted: {decrypted.decode()}")
```

Fig 1: Python implementation of RSA public and private key pair generation.

```
Debugpy/launcher: "58180" ["-"] ["c:\Users\User\OneDrive\Documents\Projects\advanced\rsa.py"]
RSA Public and Private Keys Generated.
Encrypted (Raw): b'2UdBv02Vxf36*ve2Vx85.Vx8BvbeVxc9Vxb1Vxc8sFVxb-Vx84Vef'...
Decrypted: Secret secure message.
PS C:\Users\User\OneDrive\Documents\Projects>
```

Fig 2: Terminal output demonstrating successful encryption with the public key and decryption with the private key.

Student Reflection: RSA encryption demonstrated secure communication using asymmetric cryptography. The practical showcased the strict separation of public and private keys, ensuring that messages encrypted with a public key could only be successfully decrypted by the corresponding secure private key.